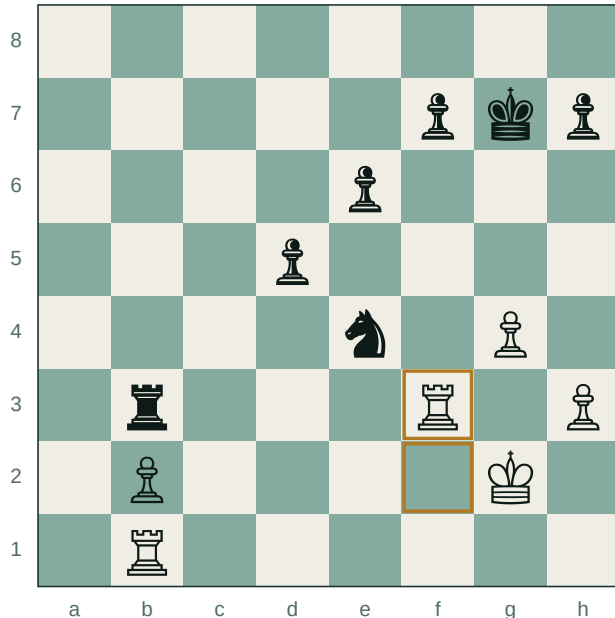


Attraction tactics: Black, move 47

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 47.Rf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

47...Rxf3 48. Kxf3 Nd2+ 49. Ke3 Nxb1

47...Rxf3 The rook captures the rook on f3. Recorded reply: **48.Kxf3**.

48...Nd2+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. From d2 it attacks king on f3 and rook on b1. Recorded reply: **49.Ke3**.

49...Nxb1 The knight captures the rook on b1.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 7 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g2. Geometrically undefended: rook on b1. Check for tactical protection.